

Compare and Contrast - Workbook 1

Compare goals, methods, and results on the same basis.

Strategy reminder

Choose one comparison basis - goal, method, attitude, result, cost, timing, or effect - and describe both sides on that same basis.

Two Cooling Strategies

Text 1

A community center considered two ways to cool an outdoor waiting area. Shade sails could be installed in one week and would provide immediate shade, but the fabric would need replacement every several years. Trees would take years to provide full shade, but mature trees could also reduce glare and provide habitat. The center decided to install two sails now and plant trees for the long term.

1. How are the shade sails and trees similar?

- A. Both can reduce direct sunlight in the waiting area
- B. Both provide full shade immediately
- C. Both require fabric replacement
- D. Both take years to work

2. What is one important difference?

- A. Only trees affect the waiting area
- B. Sails provide shade quickly, while trees take time to mature
- C. Trees are made of fabric
- D. Sails provide habitat for wildlife

Two Training Formats

Text 2

A hospital offers safety training in two formats. The live workshop allows employees to ask questions during demonstrations and practice with equipment under an instructor's supervision. The online course can be completed at any time and includes replayable videos, but employees practice with equipment later during their regular shift. Both formats cover the same safety rules.

3. How are the formats similar?

- A. Both cover the same safety rules
- B. Both require an instructor to be present at all times
- C. Both can be completed at any time
- D. Both include equipment practice during the course itself

4. What is a meaningful difference?

- A. Only the online course covers safety
- B. The live workshop includes supervised equipment practice during training, while the online course separates that practice from the course
- C. Only the workshop can use videos
- D. The online course cannot be completed by employees

Two Garden Plots

Text 3

Students studied pollinator visits in two school gardens. In Garden A, they counted every visit during three 20-minute observation periods. In Garden B, they placed a motion camera near the flowers and reviewed the recordings later. Both methods recorded more visits in the morning than in the afternoon, but the camera captured visits that occurred when no student was present.

5. How are the methods alike?

- A. Both require a motion camera
- B. Both are used to record pollinator visits
- C. Both occur only when a student is present

D. Both collect only afternoon data

6. What difference affected the amount of observation time?

A. The camera could capture visits when students were absent

B. Garden A had no flowers

C. Students reviewed no data

D. The camera could work only in the afternoon

**Review your
reasoning**

Before checking the key, mark the question that felt hardest. Write one clue that changed your mind and name the distractor that was most tempting.

Answer key and reasoning

1. A - Both options address the same goal of reducing sunlight/heat.

Watch for: A shared goal can be a meaningful similarity even when the methods differ.

2. B - Timing is a clear comparison category stated for both options.

Watch for: Do not choose a feature stated for only one option unless it establishes a true contrast.

3. A - The passage directly states that the safety content is the same.

Watch for: Do not turn one format's feature into a similarity.

4. B - The timing and supervision of practice differ between the formats.

Watch for: Compare the same feature across both options.

5. B - Both methods serve the same measurement purpose.

Watch for: A purpose can be shared even when the collection methods differ.

6. A - The camera extends observation beyond the periods when students are present.

Watch for: Choose a difference connected to the question's category: observation coverage.